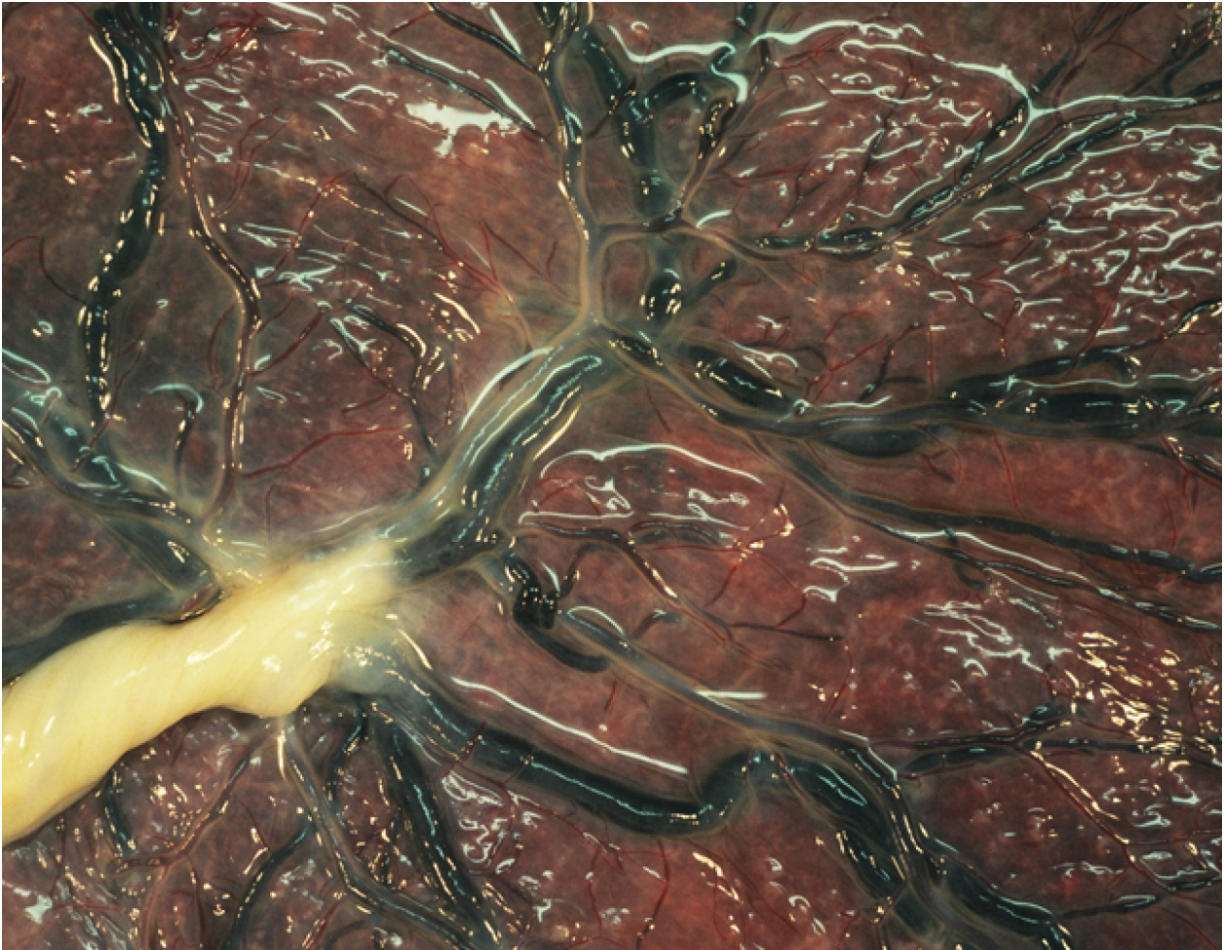


heavy bleeding occurring during the third stage, known as a [postpartum hemorrhage](#) and speeds up the delivery of the placenta, which can happen within 5 to 15 minutes after the birth of the baby. The risk of a postpartum hemorrhage occurring is the reason many units advise an active delivery. Active management of the third stage can prevent you from having excessive bleeding.

Your doctor will place one of her hands just above your pubic bone to prevent the uterus from being pulled downward when she pulls on the cord. With her other hand, she will then apply gentle traction to the cord to help deliver the membranes and placenta. This is known as “controlled cord traction” (CCT).



The disc-shaped placenta, weighing around 1 lb 2 oz (500 g), has a network of blood vessels surrounding the umbilical cord in its center.

Delivering the placenta naturally If you decide to deliver the placenta without drugs, known as a physiological third stage, this can take up to an hour. Your doctor will encourage you to bear down and you may find squatting helps. The doctor will check the placenta to ensure it's complete and that none of it remains in the uterus, which can cause a [postpartum hemorrhage](#).

How you feel after the birth

After the huge effort of giving birth, it's common to have a physical reaction. Many women experience uncontrollable shaking or shivering, and some feel nauseated and may even vomit. You are also likely to feel overwhelmed and emotional. Once you and